



Fix the Mix-Up

Quick facilitation notes & answer key

Goal

Children find the one card that breaks a pattern or group and say what it should be. Spotting and correcting a mistake is debugging — a core computational-thinking skill, and the K-appropriate first taste of fixing code.

Kindergarten frame (Ontario)

Problem Solving and Innovating — children detect and correct an error in a sequence or group.

No reading required of the child: read each prompt aloud; the child circles the wrong card and names the fix orally.

Materials

The printed worksheet + a pencil/crayon. Optional: build a pattern with blocks, slip in a wrong one, and have children find it.

Run it (about 15 min)

1. MODEL: read ● ▲ ● ▲ ■ ▲ aloud. 'It should be circle-triangle... but here is a square. That is the mix-up.' Circle it; it should be a circle.
2. GUIDED: do Exercise 1 together — the triangle does not belong in the circle group.
3. YOU TRY: children fix Exercise 2 (last star should be a square) and Exercise 3 (last triangle should be a circle).
4. Connect: 'Every coder debugs — they find a mix-up and fix it. Mistakes are okay; we just fix them.'

Answer key (modelled by the run-gate)

Model — ● ▲ ● ▲ ■ ▲ → circle the 5th card (■); it should be a circle ●.

Ex 1 — ● ● ▲ ● → circle the ▲; it should be a circle ●.

Ex 2 — ★ ■ ★ ■ ★ ★ → circle the last ★ (6th card); it should be a square ■.

Ex 3 — ▲ ● ▲ ● ▲ ▲ → circle the last ▲ (6th card); it should be a circle ●.

Watch for & differentiate

Common slip: circling more than one — there is exactly one mix-up; have them read to the end first.

Simplify: use a short 4-card pattern with the mistake near the start.

Extend: have the child make a pattern with a mix-up for a partner to find and fix.

Movement option: clap-stomp-clap-stomp-STOMP — children call out where the mix-up was.

Success looks like

The child circles the single wrong card in each item and names the correct shape it should be.